

CHAPTER 1

- Globalization has created an interdependent world community. Interdependency has brought many benefits but also raised new challenges.
- The globalized community must work across national and cultural borders to manage growing and potential international problems.
- Social challenges include population growth, migration, urbanization, and aging populations.
- Ecological concerns consist of international competition for natural resources, including water and food stocks, and environmental changes/degradation.
- Nations will have to cooperate over humanitarian and legal issues, such as disease control, natural disaster relief, and transnational crime.
- Political issues relating to international governance include the international legal system, ethics in scientific research, and human rights differences.
- Security issues that require international coordination include weapons of mass destruction, terrorists, and emerging threats such as sectarian and ethnic tensions.
- Problems relating to the study of intercultural communication encompass individual uniqueness, generalizing, lack of objectivity, and compromise.
- Communication is not a panacea for all intercultural difficulties.

CHAPTER 2

- Communication helps fulfill interpersonal needs, assists in gathering information about other people, establishes cultural and personal identities, and allows you to influence other people.
- Communication is a dynamic process in which people attempt to share their internal states with other people through the use of symbols.
- The components of communication include source, encoding, message, channel, receiver, decoding, feedback, and noise.
- Communication is dynamic, symbolic, contextual, self-reflective, irreversible, has a consequence, and is complex.
- Misconceptions about human communication are that it can solve all problems, that people are born good communicators, and that the message sent is the one that is received.
- Culture and communication are so intertwined that it is easy to think that culture is communication and that communication is culture.

CHAPTER 2

- Culture is a set of human-made objective and subjective elements that in the past have increased the probability of survival and resulted in satisfaction for the participants in an ecological niche and thus became shared among those who could communicate with each other because they had a common language and lived in the same time and place.
- Culture informs its members regarding life; therefore, it reduces confusion and helps them predict what to expect from life.
- The central characteristics of culture are that it is shared, transmitted from generation to generation, based on symbols, learned, and dynamic.
- The elements that compose culture are worldview, religion, history, values, social organization, and language.
- Intercultural competence can be developed if you are motivated, have a fund of knowledge about the other person, and possess certain communication skills.

CHAPTER 3

- The deep structures of a culture, which include such elements as family (clans), state (community), and religion (worldview), are important because they perpetuate a culture's most significant beliefs and values. Their messages endure, are deeply felt, and help supply much of a culture's identity.
- Families can take a variety of forms. The two most common are nuclear and extended.
- Traditional definitions of "family" are undergoing major changes in the United States.
- Globalization and shifting migration patterns in recent years have had major impacts on traditional family structures throughout the world.
- Families perform a series of key functions in all cultures. These functions include reproduction, economics, socialization, language acquisition, values and religion, identity, and communication.
- Cultures, by using the family as a transmitter of the key elements of culture, teach gender roles, inculcate views on individualism and collectivism, perpetuate perceptions of aging and the elderly, and develop social skills.

CHAPTER 4

TABLE 4.15 The Influence of Cultural Patterns

CULTURAL PATTERNS	
Individualism Versus Collectivism	
<i>Individualism</i> (e.g., U.S., Australia, Canada)	<i>Collectivism</i> (e.g., ROK, China, Mexico)
• Focuses on the individual and self-promotion • Independency • Task dominates relationship • Social obedience through sense of guilt	• Focuses on the group/affiliations and self-criticism • Interdependency • Relationship dominates task • Social obedience through sense of shame
Egalitarian Versus Hierarchal (Power Distance)	
<i>Egalitarian</i> (e.g., Australia, Canada, U.S.)	<i>Hierarchal</i> (e.g., Mexico, India, ROK)
• Horizontal relationships • Equality expected	• Vertical relationships • Inequality accepted
Low Versus High Uncertainty Avoidance	
<i>Low Uncertainty Avoidance</i> (e.g., Ireland, U.S.)	<i>High Uncertainty Avoidance</i> (e.g., Japan, Spain)
• Change is normal and good • Few behavioral protocols • Greater cultural diversity	• Change is disruptive and disliked • Many behavioral protocols • Less cultural diversity
Monochronic Versus Polychronic (Use of Time)	
<i>Monochronic</i> (e.g., Germany, U.S.)	<i>Polychronic</i> (e.g., Arabs, Africans, France)
• Time is linear and segmented • Focus on a single task • Adherence to schedules	• Time is flexible • Focus on multiple tasks • Weak ties to schedules

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Low Versus High Context Communication	
<i>Low Context (Direct)</i> (e.g., Germany, U.S.)	<i>High Context (Indirect)</i> (e.g., ROK, Japan)
• Meaning inherent in verbal message • Nonverbal communication low importance • Silence is avoided	• Meaning dependent on context • Nonverbal communication high importance • Silence is normal
Low Versus High Face Concerns	
<i>Low Face Concerns</i> (e.g., Canada, U.S.)	<i>High Face Concerns</i> (e.g., China, ROK)
• Conflict/disagreement is constructive • Concern for self-face	• Conflict/disagreement is threatening • Concern for mutual and other-face
Universalism Versus Particularism	
<i>Universalism</i> (e.g., U.S., UK, Australia)	<i>Particularism</i> (e.g., Russia, Japan)
• Rules and regulations apply equally to all in every situation • Relationship is subordinate to principle • There is only one truth; reality is objective	• Adherence to rules and regulations is situational • Relationship obligations may take precedence over principle • Truth is perception based; reality is subjective
<i>Source:</i> Adapted from Edwin R. McDaniel, "Bridging Cultural Differences in International Trade in Services: Communication in the Globalized Market," <i>Journal of WTO Studies</i> XXXIV(2013): 1-39.	

CHAPTER 4

- Perception may be defined as the process whereby people convert external events and experiences into meaningful internal understanding.
- Perception is the primary mechanism by which you develop your worldview.
- Perception is selective, learned, culturally determined, consistent, and often inaccurate.
- Values are enduring attitudes about the preference for one belief over another. Behaviors are the observable demonstration of internally held beliefs and values.
- Cultural pattern taxonomies are used to illustrate the dominant beliefs and values of a culture.
- When applying cultural patterns, you should keep in mind that we are more than our culture; cultural patterns are integrated, dynamic, and can be contradictory.
- According to Kohls, the dominant American cultural patterns include personal control over the environment, change, time and its control, equality, individualism/privacy, self-help, competition, future orientation, action/work orientation, informality, directness/openness/honesty, practicality/efficiency, and materialism/acquisitiveness.

CHAPTER 4

- The Kluckhohn and Strodtbeck value orientation taxonomy includes (1) human nature, (2) the perception of nature, (3) time, (4) activity, and (5) relationships.
- In Hall's context orientation, high-context and low-context describe the degree to which individuals rely on internalized information.
- A prominent taxonomy of diverse culture patterns that explains both perceptual and communication differences is Hofstede's Values Dimension, which includes (1) individualism/collectivism, (2) uncertainty avoidance, (3) power distance, (4) masculinity/ femininity, and (5) long-term/short-term orientation.
- Work by Minkov has recently revealed the value dimensions of industry/indulgence, monumentalism/flexumility, and exclusionism/universalism.
- Gelfand and her colleagues have used empirical data to demonstrate the classifications of tight and loose cultures.
- For Ting-Toomey, face and facework take different forms and are valued differently across cultures.
- Face is a function of group affiliation in collectivistic cultures and is self-derived in individualistic cultures.
- In conflict situations, collectivistic cultures focus on other-face and mutual face, while individualistic cultures focus on self-face.

CHAPTER 5

- Identity is a highly abstract, dynamic, multifaceted concept that defines who you are.
- Identities can be categorized as human, social, and personal; another classification scheme uses personal, relational, and communal.
- Every individual has multiple identities racial, gender, ethnic, national, regional, organizational, personal, and perhaps cyber/fantasy, and others—that act in concert. The importance of any single identity is a result of the context.
- Identity is acquired through interaction with other members of one's cultural group. The family exerts a primary influence on early identity formation.
- Identities are established through group membership and are enacted in various ways, including rites of passage, personal appearance, and participation in commemorative events. Concepts of identity within the same group can change over time.
- Competent intercultural communication is achieved when the participants find commonality in ascribed and avowed identities.
- As society becomes increasingly multicultural, new concepts of cultural identity are evolving.

CHAPTER 6

- Language allows people to exchange information and abstract ideas, and it is an integral part of identity.
- Language is a set of shared symbols used to create meaning. The words that people use are not only symbolic, but the relationship between the symbol and the meaning is often arbitrary. Symbols can evoke both denotative and connotative meanings.

CHAPTER 7

- Nonverbal communication is important to the study of intercultural communication because people use nonverbal communication to express internal states, create identity, regulate interaction, repeat messages, and substitute actions for words.
- Nonverbal communication is culture bound.
- Nonverbal communication involves 1 nonverbal stimuli in a communication setting that (1) are generated by various nonverbal stimuli in a communication setting and (2) have potential message value for the source and/or the receiver.
- Nonverbal messages may be intentional or unintentional.
- Nonverbal messages can work alone or in tandem with verbal messages.
- When studying nonverbal communication, it should be remembered that nonverbal messages involve multichannel activity, can be ambiguous, and are composed of numerous interacting variables.

CHAPTER 7

- Nonverbal behaviors and culture are similar in that both are learned, both are passed from generation to generation, and both involve shared understandings.
- The body is a major source of nonverbal messages. These messages are communicated by means of general appearance, judgments of beauty, skin color, attire, body movements (kinesics), posture, gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, touch, and paralanguage.
- Cultures differ in their perception and use of personal space, seating, and furniture arrangement.
- A culture's sense of time can be understood by learning how members of that culture view informal time and whether their orientation toward time is monochronic or polychronic.
- The use of silence varies from culture to culture.
- You can improve your nonverbal communication skills by keeping your interpretations tentative, being conscious of the context, employing feedback, knowing your culture, and monitoring your nonverbal actions.

CHAPTER 8

- Venturing into a new culture can cause anxiety and emotional distress, resulting in mental and physical fatigue.
- Culture shock is a mental state that can occur when moving from a familiar to an unfamiliar environment and finding that established patterns of behavior are ineffective.
- According to the U-curve model, cultural adaptation has four phases — honeymoon, disillusionment, recovery, and adjustment. Culture shock can occur during the disillusionment stage.
- Kim sees acculturation, or cultural adjustment, as a continuing process of stress-adaptation growth.
- Cultural adaptation strategies include learning about the host culture and its language, avoiding ethnocentrism, and maintaining contact with your own culture.

CHAPTER 8

- Obstacles to effective intercultural communication include a preference for similarities, dealing with uncertainty, the risk of withdrawal, stereotyping tendencies, problems of prejudice and racism, and issues of power.
- Prejudice is a strong feeling or attitude toward a particular social group or thing.
- Racism occurs when individuals believe that their race/ethnicity is superior to another race/ethnicity.
- Because communication is an activity that has a consequence, we must develop a communication ethic.
- The two major perspectives on ethics are relativism and universalism.
- An intercultural ethic asks you to be mindful of the power of communication, respect the worth of all individuals, seek commonalities among people and cultures, recognize the validity of differences, and take individual responsibility for your actions.